

Indian cricket, before and after Virat Kohli

Whether **Virat Kohli** — who has just **bid goodbye** from the Test stage as one of its greatest — **was** batting, setting the field, instructing bowlers, casually talking, **guffawing** or **prowling** the **far-flung outposts** of the ground, he **bristled with** an unstoppable enthusiasm. As though an invisible field of energy was **fuelling** and guiding him, **drawing in** the audience, their eyes, heads and hearts. India **rode the crest of the** Virat **wave** to **notch** several famous wins, **at home** and abroad, for 14 years. As much as his batting — the **refined splendour** of **strokes**, the **fusion** of **classicism** with **modernity** that would be a **thesis** for **ambitious** young batsmen — India will miss the **unwavering** and **infectious** energy that defined him.

So will world cricket. Virat **burst forth** at a time when Test cricket suffered **existential pangs**, when gifted cricketers were **forsaking** long-form **rigours** for the **lucre** and instant **gratification** of the shorter versions, when even the finest were picking and choosing their preferred formats. But Virat showed that they could be successful across formats, if they had the **will** and **wisdom**. He **walked the talk** by **scaling** the tops of batting charts in every format. He was passionate about Test cricket, spoke openly about its **primacy** over other formats, **endorsed** it in interviews and press conferences, took every opportunity to **implore** the next generation to focus on the longer game, and most importantly, cared about it. As powerful a cricketer as he is, his voice was taken seriously in the game's decision-making corridors. **World cricket**, thus, **has** lost one of its most **vociferous advocates** and **ardent** champions. He made crowds **flock** to watch Test matches and he kept the TRPs **soaring** much to the broadcasters' relief, as though **preserving** Test cricket was as big a mission as scoring hundreds and winning games.



He leaves not a hole or a crack at the heart of Indian batting, but an **emptiness** that will be difficult to fill. There is no **heir-apparent**, and even if there was one, he would have been crushed under the **immaculate** burden of being the **successor** to Kohli. In a way, it's a **tribute** to Kohli's greatness that he did not make the country miss Sachin Tendulkar for years. He was not quite Tendulkar, but he was the closest India had to him. Now India waits for someone who could be the closest they can to Kohli. Someone **eventually** will rise in this cricket-mad land, but to recreate the **unblinking** energy of Kohli could be a near impossible act.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

1. **Bid goodbye to** (phrase) – take leave of, part from, say farewell to, depart from, exit अलविदा कहना
2. **Guffawing** (noun) – laughing loudly, roaring with laughter, chuckling, cackling, howling ठहाका लगाना
3. **Prowling** (noun) – roaming, stalking, creeping, sneaking, patrolling घात लगाकर घूमना
4. **Far-flung** (adjective) – distant, remote, isolated, scattered, outlying दूरदराज
5. **Outpost** (noun) – station, base, camp, frontier post, garrison दूर का ठिकाना
6. **Bristle** (verb) – erupt, seethe, vibrate, surge, buzz उबाल आना / उत्तेजित होना
7. **Fuel** (verb) – energize, power, ignite, stimulate, drive ऊर्जा देना
8. **Draw in** (phrasal verb) – attract, engage, involve, pull in, captivate आकर्षित करना
9. **Ride the crest of the wave** (phrase) – enjoy success, be at peak, thrive, surge, prosper सफलता की ऊँचाई पर होना
10. **Notch** (verb) – achieve, secure, attain, earn, mark प्राप्त करना
11. **At home** (phrase) – domestically, within the country, on home ground, inside borders, in one's own land अपने देश में
12. **Refined** (adjective) – polished, elegant, sophisticated, graceful, cultivated परिष्कृत
13. **Splendour** (noun) – brilliance, glory, magnificence, grandeur, radiance भव्यता
14. **Stroke** (noun) – shot, hit, blow, strike, swin शॉट
15. **Fusion** (noun) – combination, blend, integration, amalgamation, merging संयोजन
16. **Classicism** (noun) – traditionalism, classic style, formalism, orthodoxy, convention शास्त्रीयता
17. **Modernity** (noun) – modernism, contemporariness, present-day thinking, innovation, progress आधुनिकता
18. **Thesis** (noun) – dissertation, argument, proposition, theory, hypothesis शोध-प्रबंध / प्रस्ताव
19. **Ambitious** (adjective) – aspiring, determined, enterprising, goal-oriented, driven महत्वाकांक्षी
20. **Unwavering** (adjective) – steady, firm, resolute, consistent, unshakeable अडिग
21. **Infectious** (adjective) – contagious, catching, spreading, compelling, irresistible प्रेरणादायक

22. **Burst forth** (phrasal verb) – emerge suddenly, erupt, break out, appear, spring up फूट पड़ना
23. **Existential** (adjective) – relating to existence, life-threatening, philosophical, fundamental, crucial अस्तित्व से संबंधित
24. **Pang** (noun) – ache, stab, twinge, spasm, discomfort पीड़ा
25. **Forsake** (verb) – abandon, leave, give up, renounce, desert त्याग देना
26. **Rigour** (noun) – discipline, severity, hardship, intensity, strictness कठोर परिस्थितियाँ
27. **Lucre** (noun) – money, profit, gain, wealth, earnings लाभ
28. **Gratification** (noun) – satisfaction, pleasure, fulfillment, delight, reward संतुष्टि
29. **Will** (noun) – determination, resolve, drive, intention, purpose इच्छा शक्ति
30. **Wisdom** (noun) – insight, understanding, knowledge, sense, judgment बुद्धिमत्ता
31. **Walk the talk** (phrase) – act accordingly, follow through, practice what you preach, deliver, fulfill कहे अनुसार करना
32. **Scale** (verb) – climb, reach, ascend, achieve, rise चढ़ना / प्राप्त करना
33. **Primacy** (noun) – importance, supremacy, precedence, dominance, preeminence प्रधानता
34. **Endorse** (verb) – support, approve, advocate, promote, back समर्थन करना
35. **Implore** (verb) – beg, urge, plead, appeal, request विनती करना
36. **Vociferous** (adjective) – outspoken, loud, forceful, vehement, boisterous मुखर / जोरदार
37. **Advocate** (noun) – supporter, promoter, proponent, campaigner, defender समर्थक
38. **Ardent** (adjective) – passionate, fervent, enthusiastic, zealous, devoted उत्साही / प्रबल
39. **Flock** (to) (verb) – gather, rush, swarm, assemble, crowd झुंड बनाकर आना
40. **Soar** (verb) – rise, increase, climb, escalate, surge ऊँचाई पर पहुँचना
41. **Preserve** (verb) – maintain, protect, conserve, safeguard, uphold संरक्षित करना
42. **Emptiness** (noun) – void, blankness, nothingness, hollowness, vacancy खालीपन
43. **Heir-apparent** (noun) – successor, inheritor, crown prince, next in line, nominee संभावित उत्तराधिकारी

44. **Immaculate** (adjective) – flawless, perfect, spotless, pristine, unblemished बेदाग

45. **Successor** (noun) – replacement, heir, follower, inheritor, next उत्तराधिकारी

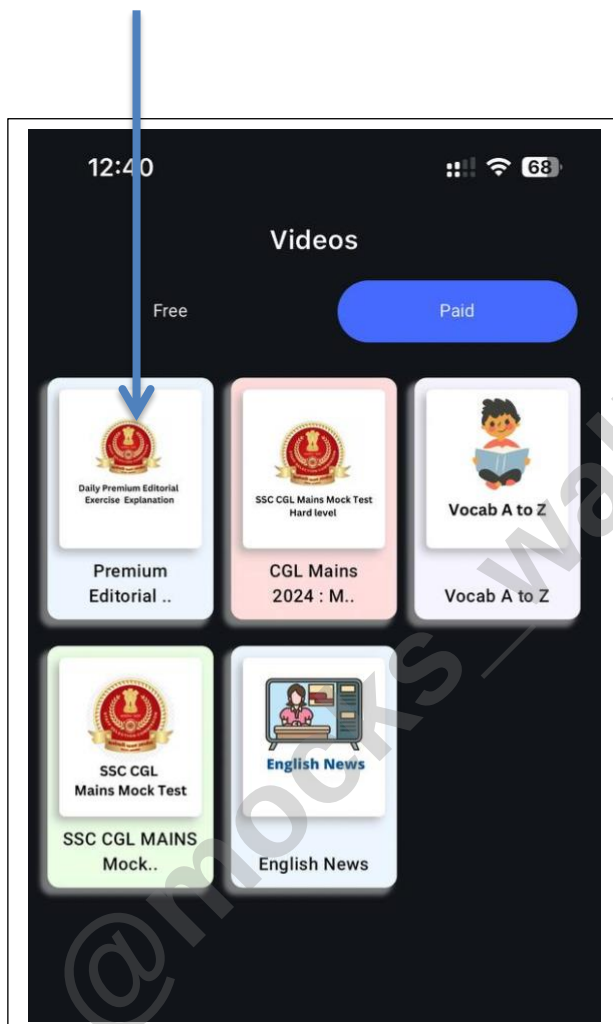
46. **Tribute** (noun) – praise, homage, salute, honour, acknowledgment श्रद्धांजलि / सम्मान

47. **Eventually** (adverb) – finally, ultimately, in time, at last, sooner or later अंततः

48. **Unblinking** (adjective) – unwavering, steady, fixed, intense, focused अटल

@mocks_wallah

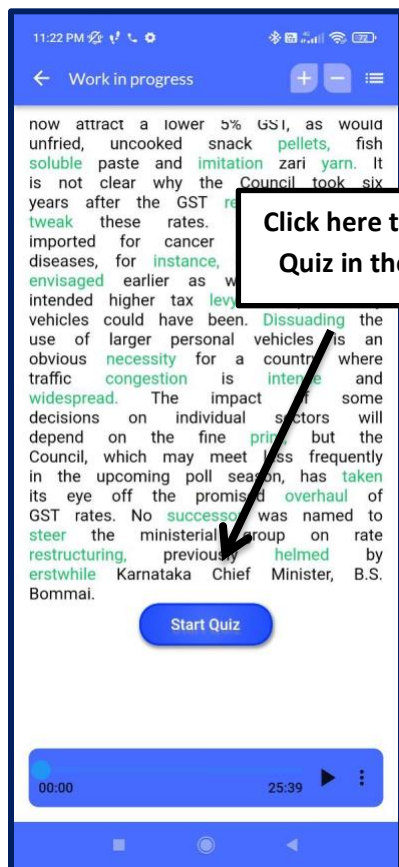
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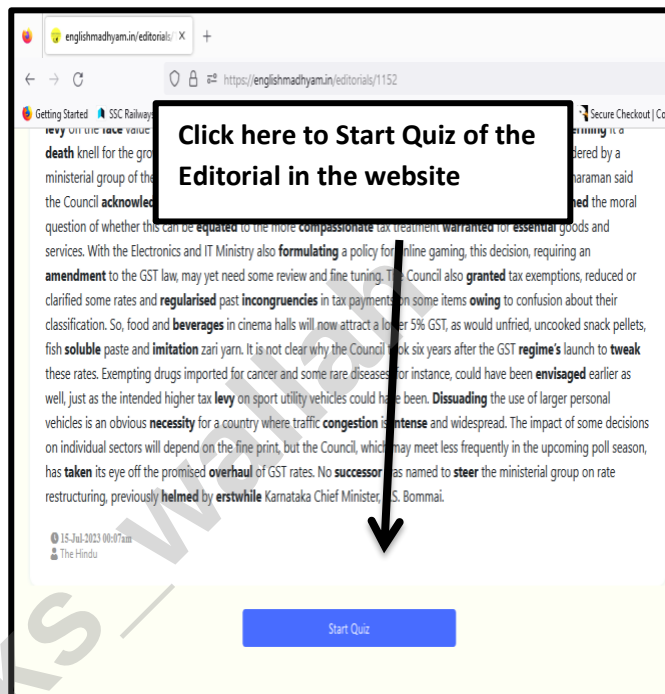
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Virat Kohli** has retired from Test cricket, leaving behind a legacy as one of the game's greatest players.
2. He brought **unmatched energy and enthusiasm** to every aspect of the game—batting, fielding, leading, and even casual interactions on the field.
3. Kohli's presence energized fans and teammates alike, creating an invisible force that drew audiences in.
4. For 14 years, **India achieved several major victories** at home and abroad riding on the "Virat wave."
5. His **batting style**—a blend of classical elegance and modern aggression—served as an ideal for young cricketers.
6. Beyond statistics, it is Kohli's **infectious passion and intensity** that Indian cricket will deeply miss.
7. Globally, cricket will also feel the void left by Kohli, especially in the context of **Test cricket's declining appeal**.
8. He emerged during a time when many players were shifting to shorter formats, but he **championed all formats** with equal success.
9. Kohli **led by example**, topping batting charts across all formats while maintaining a strong commitment to Test cricket.
10. He vocally **advocated for the primacy of Test cricket**, urging younger players to value and focus on it.
11. His stature in the game meant his **words carried weight** in cricket's policy and decision-making circles.
12. Kohli helped **revive interest in Test matches**, keeping TRPs high and filling stadiums, which was a boon for broadcasters.
13. His retirement leaves a **deep emotional and symbolic void** in Indian batting, not just a technical gap.
14. There is currently **no clear successor** to Kohli; any potential one would face immense pressure.
15. Just as Kohli helped India move on from Sachin Tendulkar, now **India waits for someone who can make them forget Kohli**—a daunting task given his unique charisma and influence.

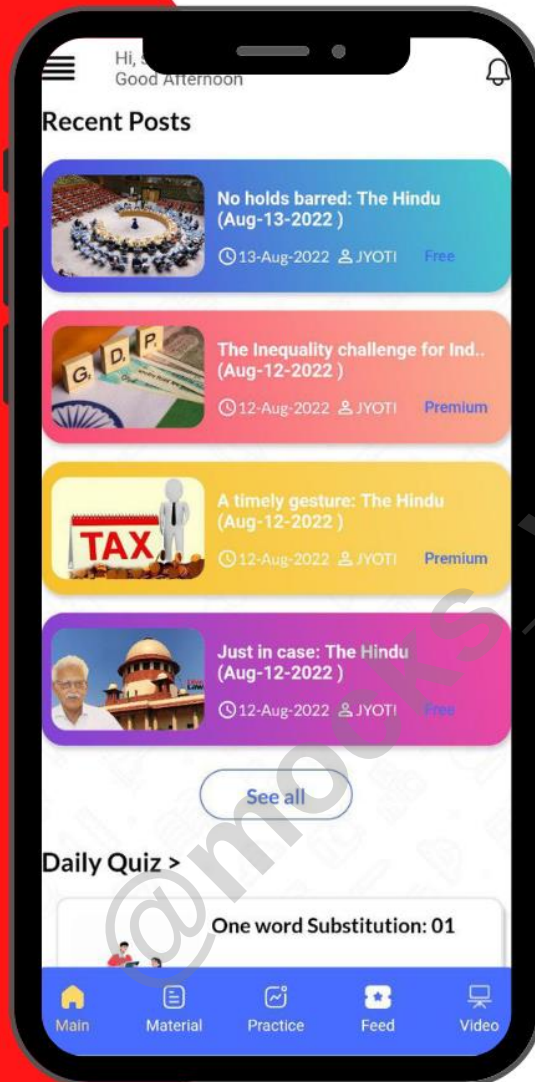
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